

ENGLISH LANGUAGE PAPER 4

PART A Group Interaction

Below is an extract from a local newspaper:

Simplicity has its own rewards

Mok Ho-kwong is no ordinary environmentalist. He doesn't just talk about his ideals but puts most of them into practice. He lives in a remote village house in Fanling, where he grows his own vegetables.

His house has few electrical appliances and no air-conditioning or television.

The 30-year-old university graduate makes his own soap, uses only salt to clean his teeth, picks up furniture thrown out by others and occasionally burns waste wood to cook.

He says most quality-of-life issues facing urban dwellers, such as rising home prices, air pollution, income inequality and food safety scares, are a matter of choice. 'I have spacious living here and right outside I can breathe very good air. Whenever I want fresh and safe food I harvest whatever I need from my farm. This is a quality life. Everyone is able to live it, but many can't leave the city, which is too convenient for them.'

Mok doesn't care much about what he earns, as long as it covers his expenses and rent. 'The more money you make, the more you want,' he says, 'which pressures you to get more. And I don't have this anxiety now.'

Your school wants to organise a one-month-long course on simple living. As part of the course, students have to live in the countryside for a week like Mok Ho-kwong. You may want to talk about:

- the skills that students will learn from this course
- the benefits and problems this plan will bring
- what other activities to include in the course
- anything else you think is important

PART B Individual Response

1. Do you enjoy spending time in the countryside?
2. Would you like to live a simple life in the countryside?
3. Do you think people in Hong Kong need to know about nature?
4. Do you think that living in the countryside would make everyone happier?
5. If you could choose only one household electrical appliance to have, what would it be?
6. Do you think people can be happy without money?
7. Do you think everyone could live a simple life like Mok Ho-kwong?
8. Do you agree with the statement, 'The more money you make, the more you want'?